

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

The Secrets to a Healthy Old Age

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 18

No.	Sentence
1	Ageing is partly linked to the _____ of the body's cells.
2	Earlier explanations focused mainly on _____ processes; newer research also considers how people live in society.
3	A recent paper suggests that _____ of ageing can be influenced by how people live.
4	Alongside diet, a _____ may matter for health in later life.
5	Researchers followed _____ over their lives to examine differences in health.
6	Older people may feel _____, which can have a serious effect on health.
7	The impact of this isolation is compared with that of _____.
8	In Mediterranean countries, the climate encourages _____ outdoors.
9	People may share _____ and live with family members of different generations.
10	Wherever people live, keeping in _____ with other people may help them age well.

11 What is the main change in researchers' understanding of ageing described in the discussion?

- A They now see ageing as completely preventable through medical treatment.
- B They now consider social and lifestyle factors alongside changes in cells.
- C They now regard inherited traits as less important than a person's age.
- D They now believe the body's cells remain unchanged during later life.

12 What does the figure from the recent paper suggest about ageing?

- A A substantial share may be influenced by the way people live.
- B Most people will remain healthy until the age of sixty.
- C Lifestyle explains every difference between older people.
- D Cell changes account for exactly sixty per cent of ageing.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **What did the twin studies described by Professor Harper do?**
- A Keep the twins' diets identical throughout adulthood.
 - B Compare medical treatments given after retirement.
 - C Measure participants' attitudes in a single short interview.
 - D Follow twins over time and compare their outlook with later health.
- 14 **According to the twin studies, how did outlook relate to health in later life?**
- A A positive outlook prevented all signs of physical ageing.
 - B A negative outlook improved health when diet was controlled.
 - C A positive outlook was associated with better later-life health.
 - D Both outlooks produced similar health as the twins grew older.
- 15 **An older person eats well but has little social contact. What concern follows from the discussion?**
- A Diet alone may leave a health-related risk unaddressed.
 - B A healthy diet is likely to cause more loneliness.
 - C Outdoor exercise would certainly remove the risk.
 - D A multigenerational home would be the only solution.
- 16 **What is the point of describing the Mediterranean way of life beyond its food?**
- A To show that its meals are healthier when eaten outdoors.
 - B To show that its benefits may involve exercise and social routines too.
 - C To show that diet matters only in warm countries.
 - D To show that living with relatives replaces the need for exercise.
- 17 **What can be inferred about the value of communal meals in this discussion?**
- A They are valuable mainly because every dish contains fish.
 - B They are valuable only when several generations prepare them.
 - C They guarantee that people will never experience loneliness.
 - D They may support the social contact linked to ageing well.
- 18 **What is the most reasonable practical message for someone living outside the Mediterranean?**
- A Move to a warmer country before changing any daily habits.
 - B Copy Mediterranean meals exactly to gain the same results.
 - C Cultivate a positive outlook and make time for social contact.
 - D Depend mainly on inherited traits to determine future health.